



Malawi Revenue Authority

TRAINING POLICY

Revised January 2019

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1 INTRODUCTION

- 1.1 The Malawi Revenue Authority (MRA) is committed to developing a strong learning culture, in which everyone is able to achieve their full potential, and which will increase job satisfaction and support career development. As such, the MRA is committed to providing excellent training and development opportunities for its staff, which meet the operational and strategic objectives of the organisation, as well as individuals' own learning aspirations and needs.
- 1.2 MRA is committed to ensuring that all members of staff are provided with the training they need to perform their jobs safely at all times. As such, the Authority will maintain and keep under review a list of training that is mandatory for some or all staff members, and ensure that appropriate training is available at the required intervals.
- 1.3 The Authority is aware that resources, including funding, time, and effective use of internal expertise, will be required to achieve success in this area. The Authority is committed to identifying and allocating such resources as required, within the constraints placed on it. In addition, sources of external funding will be identified wherever possible.
- 1.4 The Authority will ensure that all staff training and development activities are developed, managed and delivered with due regard to fairness and equity. All applications for staff training and development activities will be considered strictly on merit and relevance.

2 PURPOSE

This Training Policy and procedures is aimed at:

- 2.1 Ensuring that all learning, training and development interventions are transparently, objectively and consistently managed in the Authority; and that there is accountability at all levels.
- 2.2 Describing the main aspects of the Authority's provision for learning, training and Development activities
- 2.3 Articulating the focus of learning, training and development activities in the Authority
- 2.4 Inform officers about learning, training and development opportunities and how to access them
- 2.5 Providing a framework within which learning, training and development activities may vary but the overall approach, skills, and behaviors required to be developed remains consistent;
- 2.6 Clarifying roles and responsibilities of all key players in the management of the learning, training and development function.

3 GUIDING PRINCIPLES

Administration of the training policy shall be driven by the following principles:

- 3.1 The Authority will only support accredited training programmes offered by institutions accredited by National Council of Higher Education (NCHE) or internationally recognized universities.
- 3.2 Only training and staff development programmes that are related to the Authority's business, identified needs and demands in line with strategic and operational objectives of the Authority shall be approved;
- 3.3 Priorities shall be established so that the most relevant training is given to the most suitable officers at the right time for the attainment of goals and objectives of the Authority.
- 3.4 Divisions/departments shall attribute a percentage of their annual budgets to training.
- 3.5 In all cases of educational scholarships and loans, the beneficiary shall be bonded accordingly upon acceptance/receipt of such scholarship or loan. The bond may be varied where it is work based learning such as e-learning.
- 3.6 Educational loans shall be recoverable over a period of eighteen (18) months.
- 3.7 Training shall support each employee's performance requirements in the current job or potential for a future assignment identified in a performance review or career and development plan.
- 3.8 Training shall be systematic whereby the needs of operation and support areas are identified and any subsequent training should be delivered and evaluated in response to those needs.
- 3.9 Managers shall be responsible and accountable for providing staff with adequate opportunities and resources for timely training, for applying new skills, knowledge and attitudes and for reinforcement and coaching where required.
- 3.10 Each employee and his/her manager share joint responsibility to identify the employee's training and development needs and planning training and development commensurate with their skills & knowledge needs.
- 3.11 This policy shall only apply to all those who have served the institution in continuous employment for a period of two (2) years and more
- 3.12 Unpaid study leave shall be granted to an officer at the discretion of the Commissioner General and where the officer has been with the Authority on continuous employment for five (5) years and more
- 3.13 To give chance to others to benefit as well from the scholarships, an employee will only be provided with an opportunity to complete only one

professional qualification, one bachelor's degree, one master's degree and a PhD during his/her career with the Authority.

- 3.14 The Authority shall not provide graduation expenses to support officers who studied locally or abroad as part of the Educational loan or MRA sponsorship. Officers, who wish to attend their graduation ceremonies, shall be requested to make personal arrangements or take a personal loan to cover for their expenses. A personal loan attracts interest.
- 3.15 Subsequent payment of course fees and examination fees by MRA to a training Institution will only be effected upon the officer submitting examination results of the preceding year.
- 3.16 Contractual employees shall not be entitled to full time, long term training sponsorship of more than six (6) months.
- 3.17 Once an employee has been granted a course approval and or time off, it is expected that the employee will finalise his or her studies within five years from the date of the approval.
- 3.18 Officers who do not complete their studies within five years from the date of approval, will be requested to seek an extension of approval to the Director, Human Resource & Organizational Development through their Division Heads stating reasons for the delay in completion of studies.
- 3.19 The Authority may grant extensions but shall not in total exceed two (2) academic years
- 3.20 Officers will not be allowed to change field of study or training institution on their own without prior approval of the Training Committee.
- 3.21 Officers on paid and unpaid study leave will be requested to seek approval from the Director of Human Resources of any intention to extend their study leave duration and the justification thereof, failure of which will be construed as a disciplinary matter
- 3.22 Officers who drop out of the training midway before finalising their studies, shall not be allowed to apply for another training opportunity until the period they would have served the training bond expires.
- 3.23 Considering the nature of our business, only officers who have served the Authority on continuous employment for Seven (7) years and more, can be allowed to pursue PhD Programmes.
- 3.24 PhD study applications shall only be allowed based on the Authority's needs assessment. The applications must be relevant to the Authority's current and/or future needs as determined by the Authority.
- 3.25 A needs assessment shall be conducted before approval is granted to ensure that the PhD is necessary and in line with the needs of the Authority.

3.26 Officers pursuing PhD programmes shall be bonded accordingly for a period equivalent to the duration of the PhD.

3.27 Considering the longevity and cost of PhD the Authority will allow: -

- 1) A maximum of five (5) openings once every three (3) years;
- 2) A maximum of two (2) officers per division once every three (3) years;
- 3) Sponsor at least two (2) officers once every three years; and
- 4) PhDs that are fully or partially funded by organizations or persons other than MRA shall be prioritised.

3.28 A PhD holder's remuneration may be reviewed accordingly to take recognition of the qualification without specifically changing the grade of the incumbent.

3.29 Officers who deliberately decide to leave the Authority before the expiry of the bonding period shall be required to pay the Authority a sum of money equivalent to 50% of their salary and expenses the Authority spent for the duration of the study period for the remaining unserved bond duration given by the Authority for purposes of attending the training.

4 TYPES OF TRAINING PROGRAMMES

MRA intends to run the following types of training programmes:

4.1 Induction Programmes

MRA shall run induction programmes designed to orient new employees with basic knowledge and skills necessary for efficient and effective performance on the job and also orient the new recruits on the various administration and personnel policies of the Authority.

The induction programme shall apply to all new staff including those staff employed on a temporary basis.

4.2 Refresher Programmes

Refresher programmes will be designed with the view to develop the professional competence of staff within their respective fields of practice.

4.3 Advanced Training Programmes

MRA shall run advanced programmes whose primary objective is to upgrade, broaden, deepen and sharpen employee knowledge and skills. These will be run between six (6) and twelve (12) months after the basic training.

4.4 On - the Job Training

Human Resource quality improvement interventions shall not be restricted to formal training. On- the job training shall be the priority especially in cases where new recruits cannot have formal basic class training and for potential employees identified for the purposes of succession planning.

Specifically, on the Job training shall involve:

- 1) Identification of on- the job trainees, their training needs and mentors.
- 2) Drawing and implementation of the training work plan to be monitored by the Human Resource Division in collaboration with the mentor and the trainee's line manager.
- 3) Evaluation of the effectiveness of the on- the job training by the Human Resource Division in collaboration with the mentor and the trainee's line manager.

4.5 Part Time Training

MRA shall strive to provide an enabling learning environment to persons who have demonstrated personal initiative for self-development relevant to their career. In the provision of this support, MRA shall ensure that self-initiated training shall not be at the cost of its business. The support shall be offered in:

- 1) Allowing time off for employees obtaining relevant training lessons and seating for examinations offered by reputable and recognised training institutions.
- 2) Provision of loans to employees attending part-time training sessions relevant to MRA's business and their career orientation.

5 FINANCING TRAINING PROGRAMMES

To foster deliberate efforts to carry out human development plans, the Authority shall ensure that a percentage of the annual budget is devoted to training and development. The Authority shall further be driven by the following financial arrangements and principles:

- 5.1 The Authority shall recognize both self-funded and Authority funded programmes.
- 5.2 The Authority's funding shall be either in the provision of a scholarship or a loan.
- 5.3 A beneficiary to the Authority's scholarship or loan shall be bonded at the time the funding is provided.
- 5.4 An educational loan shall be recoverable over a period of eighteen (18) months.
- 5.5 Officers who opt to finance themselves through their resources or personal loans shall not claim a refund.
- 5.6 Officers pursuing PhDs may get educational loan but the Authority shall not undertake to reimburse the cost upon successful completion of the studies.

6 TRAINING RESPONSIBILITIES

The Human Resource Division in collaboration with operational and support divisions/departments is responsible for providing institutional leadership in the Authority sponsored training by ensuring best practices,

developing and delivering mandated and other priority training courses, monitoring and evaluating all training activities.

6.1 Executive Management

For purpose of this policy, the responsibility of the Executive Management shall be to ensure that policy statements and practices promote continuous development with special emphasis towards improvement of performance. They should in particular: -

- 1) Approve training and development policies and level of resources to be allocated in support of them.
- 2) Be involved in training decisions and formal training events.
- 3) Through the feedback processes ensure that training interventions provide quality control service for the training function.

6.2 Line Management

For the purpose of the policy the responsibility of Line Managers shall be *inter alia*;

- 1) To implement the authority's training and development policy within their own spheres of influence.
- 2) To identify and discuss training and development needs with subordinates through the performance management system and other tools.
- 3) To decide and agree with their staff the type and quality of training and development activities to be undertaken.
- 4) To coach, counsel, mentor and train staff either on the job or off the job.
- 5) To assess the effectiveness of training in contributing to individual or organisational performance.
- 6) To create an environment in which continuous development can prosper and succeed.
- 7) To provide appropriate opportunities for their staff to participate in training and development initiatives.
- 8) To assist staff in identification of training needs and appropriate training intervention in line strategic objectives and the Authority's business.
- 9) To authorize training requests on the relevant course Requisition Form.

6.3 Training Coordinators/Trainers

For purpose of this policy Training Coordinators/Trainers will interface with the Human Resource Division, in the following activities:-

1. Coordinating divisional training programmes.
2. Providing information to Human Resources Division on all technical courses.
3. Ensuring that trainers are identified for technical courses and are technically competent.
4. Ensuring that candidates are nominated well in advance for both technical and corporate courses.

6.4 **Individual Employees**

Individual employees will be particularly responsible for:-

1. Jointly with their line managers, and through the MRA performance management system, identify and arrange training and development needs, and also together with the manager develop individual training and personal development action plans.
2. Fully committing themselves and managing their learning for themselves.

6.5 **The Institute of Tax Administration (ITA)**

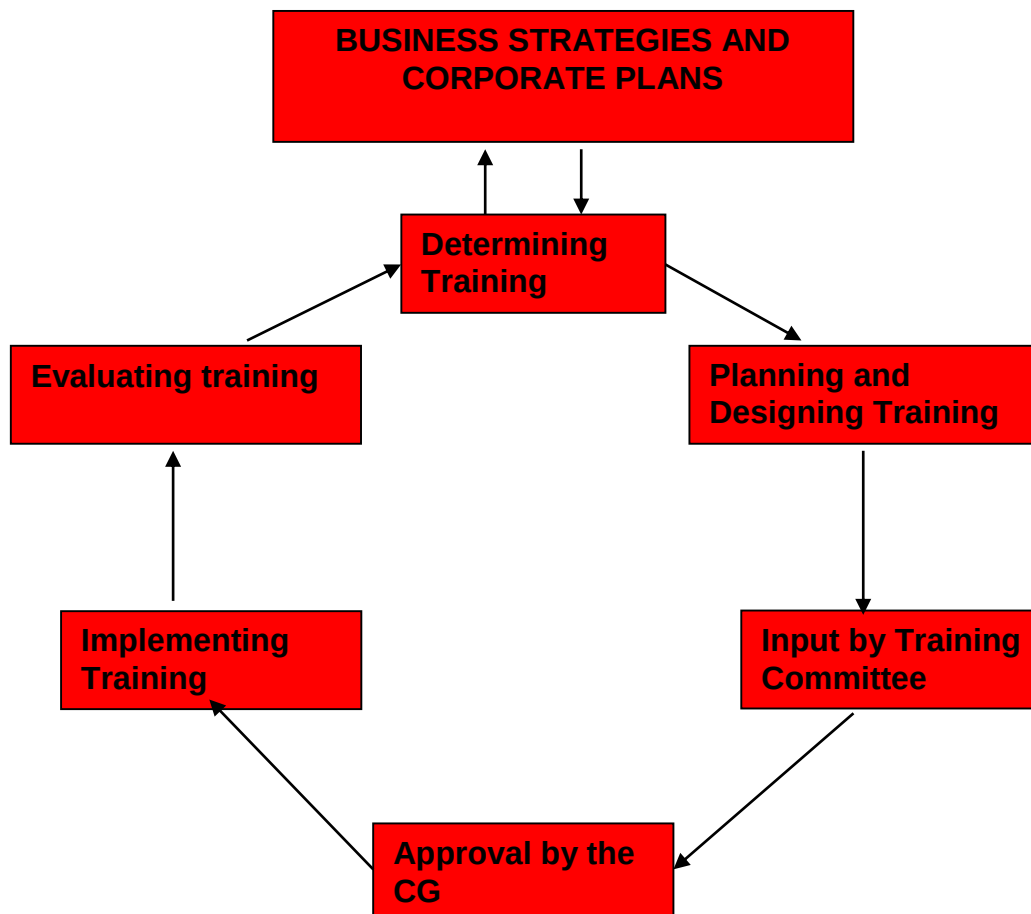
For the purpose of the policy the responsibility of the ITA shall be *inter alia*;

1. To interpret and implement the authority's training and development policy
2. Conduct training needs analysis at the beginning of each year and produce a comprehensive report to management
3. Coordinate, guide members, and act as secretariat for the Training Committee
4. Scrutinize and provide feedback to all training or sponsorship applications
5. Host residential and non-residential training programmes on behalf of divisions
6. Develop and deliver in-house soft skills management programmes for the divisions.
7. As an output as well as input of training and development, ITA will interpret, guide management and follow up on Talent Management, Succession Planning and Competency frameworks for the divisions

7 THE TRAINING PROCESS

7.1 The Systematic Training Cycle

All MRA training interventions shall follow the systematic training cycle.



7.2 Determining Training Needs

For the identification of training needs, the Authority shall carry out Training Needs Analyses (TNA) and Performance Appraisals. The format for Training Needs Analysis is attached as **Appendix 1**.

8.2.1 Training Needs Analysis (TNA)

The Authority shall carry out TNA in order to identify training and development needs for all staff. The process shall always begin with identification of organisational, divisional and departmental goals and objectives. Following this, a job analysis shall be carried out using a variety of methods for identification of training and development needs for staff namely;

- i. Interviews
- ii. Questionnaires
- iii. Group methods
- iv. Critical incident technique

8.2.2 Performance Appraisal Management System

The Performance Appraisal Management System shall form part of the main methods for determining training and development needs of staff. While the purpose of Performance Appraisal Management is to periodically review each employee's work performance in order to promote the most effective use of expertise and to recognise achievements, it will also assist to highlight the following;

1. The training needs of an individual by showing where his performance is below the required level.
2. Individual's potential for further development including competence.
3. The effectiveness of previous training if any was provided.

All training needs, especially those that arise as a result of performance deficiencies or of a development nature or lateral or promotional moves, must be discussed openly between supervisors and the subordinates during the performance appraisal interview using the MRA balanced Score Cards.

Where performance deficiencies are not as a result of lack of training, coaching or counselling may be used to rectify the situation.

Once training needs have been identified and established, the ITA will compile a comprehensive schedule of these needs at individual, occupational and organisation levels.

8.2.3 Training Needs Identification

When deciding the type of training required to meet the training needs of each employee the following should be adhered to:-

1. All training should emanate from established training needs and carefully thought career and development planning.
2. Each and every training programme should have learning objectives expressed as far as possible in behavioural terms, or in competencies specifying the performance evidence required.
3. Each employee should be encouraged to give his/her views/suggestions on the training being recommended.

8 DEVELOPMENT OF A PRIORITISED TRAINING PLAN

1. After identifying the training needs, the next stage shall be the development of a Prioritised Training Plan.
2. Each Division shall be expected to develop annual training plans for both short and long term trainings.
3. The Human Resource Division shall consolidate the training plans submitted by the divisions to ensure they reflect the priority training needs of the Authority.
4. The Learning and Organizational Development unit of HR will analyse the training plans in line with Division's business needs and in accordance with strategic objectives of MRA.
5. The Format of the Training Plan is attached as **Appendix 2**

9 SELECTION CRITERIA AND PROCEDURE FOR SHORT TERM TRAINING PROGRAMS

Short term training shall be defined as any training whose duration is less than six months. An officer shall be eligible for short term training on the following conditions:

1. Selection of employees to undergo short term trainings shall be based on the prioritised training plans of the Division.
2. Identification of training beneficiaries shall be based on a systematic training needs analysis to ensure return on investment in training and staff development.
3. The training program should be relevant to the officer's field of work
4. Selection of training beneficiaries shall be based on equitable gender balance and geographical distribution of Stations across all the regions.
5. Unless otherwise stated, priority shall be given to officers who have not attended any course during the previous year in order to ensure that more officers benefit.
6. For any identified training course, the officer will discuss with the line manager or supervisor on the need to attend the training based on the prioritised training plan of the division and the training needs of the officer.
7. The line manager/supervisor will present the training need to the Divisional Head, and having being satisfied on the need for the training, the Divisional Head will seek the approval of the Commissioner General for the officer to attend the training.
8. Upon return from any short term training program, an officer is expected to submit a report and action plan on the training attended to the Divisional Head through his/her line manager or supervisor within two weeks upon reporting for duties. The format for Back to Office Report is attached as **Appendix 2**.

9. Share with his/her colleagues the knowledge and skills acquired from the training program through briefing sessions.

10 SELECTION CRITERIA FOR LONG TERM TRAINING PROGRAMS

Unless otherwise stipulated, long term training shall be defined as any training whose duration is six (6) months and above. Selection of officers for long term training, shall be based on the following criteria:

- 10.1 Selection of officers shall be based on priority training and staff development needs of the Authority without discrimination.
- 10.2 Consideration shall be given to employees who have worked for the Authority for two years and more for professional training programs, bachelor's degree and master's degree, and seven years for PHD programs, except as otherwise dictated by the Authority immediate training needs
- 10.3 In line with the Government Training Policy, employees to be considered for long term training programs leading to academic awards must not be more than fifty (50) years
- 10.4 Employees shall be recommended to pursue long term training programs overseas provided that same/similar programs are not offered locally or within the region.
- 10.5 Prior to departure for training, an employee must prepare and submit handover notes to his/her supervisor and work colleagues.

11 PROCEDURE FOR EDUCATION LOANS AND SCHOLARSHIP APPLICATIONS

The Authority will grant study education loans and scholarships to eligible employees to enable them improve their professional qualifications provided that their preferred courses of study are relevant to their work.

11.1 Eligibility and procedure for Education Loan.

An employee who wishes to be considered for a study loan will: -

- 11.1.1 Write a Training Application Memo/email expressing interest to study to the line manager or supervisor stating the course of study and relevance of the course.
- 11.1.2 The line manager or supervisor will recommend the training course for approval to the Head of Division after being satisfied that the training is in line with the strategic needs and the long term training plans of the division, and whether due to the nature of the job, the officer can be allowed time off or study leave without interfering with the work flow process
- 11.1.3 Once approved, the officer will then apply at the training institution
- 11.1.4 When the officer has received an offer letter from the training institution, he or she will fill out the Training Application Forms which will

be submitted to Human Resources through his or her Division Head for recommendation for approval by the Training Committee.

- 11.1.5 The Human Resource will check the forms for eligibility for loan in terms of whether the officer has been with the Authority for two years on full time employment, is not on contract, and that the officer is not serving a bond or was already sponsored for that particular program or similar during his/her career in MRA.
- 11.1.6 Education loan shall not be extended to cover graduation expenses; those who wish to travel to their graduation ceremonies shall make their own arrangements. Only on special considerations and with approval from the commissioner General, an employee will be offered a personal loan to cover for his/her graduation expenses. Personal loan attracts interest rates.
- 11.1.7 The Authority will only reimburse costs related to educational loan effective date of approval, and consequently, all costs incurred before approval was sought are not refundable.
- 11.1.8 Subsequent payment of course fees and examination fees by MRA to a training Institution will only be effected upon the officer submitting examination results of the preceding year.
- 11.1.9 Employees who fail in subjects for which the loan was obtained shall not be entitled to subsequent loans for the same training/module
- 11.1.10 Employees will not be allowed to change field of study or training institution on their own without prior approval of the Training Committee
- 11.1.11 Employees who drop out of the training midway before finalizing their studies, will not be allowed to apply for another training opportunity until two years elapses, which is in essence the minimum period they would have served the training bond.
- 11.1.12 Employees who would want to undertake self-development training, which is not identified as a need for the Authority, may be granted educational loan by the Authority. If granted, the Authority shall recover that loan and the employee shall not be entitled to reimbursement after successful completion of such training.
- 11.1.13 The maximum repayment period for all study loans shall be eighteen (18) months or the remaining portion of contract in case of contract staff.
- 11.1.14 PhD educational loans shall not be reimbursed after successful completion of the training.

11.2 Eligibility and procedure for MRA Sponsorship

To be eligible for MRA sponsorship or donor funded scholarship the following procedure has to be followed.

- 11.2.1 At the beginning of each Financial Year, Human Resource Division will request Divisions to submit long term training areas for possible sponsorship by MRA or donor funded scholarships together with the proposed list of officers earmarked for such sponsorships.
- 11.2.2 The Human Resource Division shall consolidate the training plans submitted by the divisions to ensure they reflect the priority training needs of the Authority.
- 11.2.3 When a training opportunity arises, the Divisional Head in liaison with Human Resource Division will notify eligible officers to apply for such courses.
- 11.2.4 When the officer is successful in their application, the officer will then fill out the Training Application Form and submit to Human Resource for the Training Committee to approve
- 11.2.5 Once the Training Committee approves, the names will then be submitted to the Commissioner General for endorsement and approval of the recommendation of the Training Committee.

11.3 Eligibility for Donor Funded Scholarships

- 11.3.1 When there are opportunities for scholarships, the Human Resource Division will first seek approval from the Commissioner General for officers to apply for the scholarship
- 11.3.2 Once the Commissioner General has approved, the Human Resource Division will request relevant Divisions to nominate officers from their list of eligible officers in the Long Term Training Plans to apply
- 11.3.3 Officers who are successful and have been offered scholarships, shall fill out and submit the Training Application Form, attaching offer letter and other relevant documentation to the Human Resource Division for Training Committee Approval.
- 11.3.4 Once the Training Committee approves, the names will then be submitted to the Commissioner General for endorsement and approval of the recommendations of the Training Committee.
- 11.3.5 Officers who are awarded self-initiated scholarships but are not on the prioritised annual training plans of the Division, may be granted unpaid study leave, so long the training program is relevant to the officer's duties and responsibilities, have served the Authority on continuous basis for five years and is not currently serving a training bond

12 PART TIME COURSES

MRA will encourage and support employees undertaking self-development activities to progress on their own careers.

12.1 Application for Part Time Training

The process of application for part time training is the same as that for full time training. All part time training must be approved by Commissioner General through the Training Committee.

12.2 Eligibility

To be considered for part time training an employee must have been confirmed and must have worked in the Authority for not less than seven (7) years for PhDs and two (2) years for the rest of the programmes.

12.3 Time off for Classes

Employees attending approved part time courses will be given time off to attend classes, e.g. day release and actual examination. Where there is a specific need for day or part day, release to attend classes, time off with pay shall be granted.

13 ATTACHMENT

13.1 In accordance with procedures laid down in the policy, MRA will engage the services of college students and take them as temporally employees on non-established post. Also MRA will make provision for attachments in other organisations for professional employees e.g. lawyers and accountants to enable them hone their skills.

13.2 The students would not be graded but would only be on flat allowances according to the years of study as follows:

13.3 Second Year College students will be placed on a flat allowance equivalent to 60% of the basic salary of grade F2.

13.4 Third and fourth year college students be placed on a flat allowance equivalent to 80% of the basic salary of grade F2.

14 PAID STUDY LEAVE

14.1 Paid study leave shall be granted by management to employees for study purposes, upon fulfilling all the training requirements which are of interest to MRA; conferences, seminars, workshops, fellowships, training courses as well as undertaking Study Tours and writing Examinations.

14.2 The period of an employees' paid study leave will count as continued service with the Authority and will qualify for leave.

14.3 Officers seeking to extend their study leave duration will be requested to seek the approval of the Director of Human Resources of their intention to

extend the duration and the justification thereof, failure of which will be construed as a disciplinary matter.

- 14.4 While on approved training, the officer will only be entitled to his or her salary at the point prior to going on training and will not receive annual increments as he or she does not earn them while on training.
- 14.5 Upon completion of his or her training and returning to his or her duty station, the officer will be placed at a salary point as if he or she continued to receive annual increments during the duration of study but will not be entitled to any payment of arrears.
- 14.6 Successful completion of a degree program will not automatically guarantee an officer for promotion
- 14.7 An officer on paid study leave will only be eligible for promotion on competitive process like any other employee in the Authority after successful completion of the course of study subject to availability of a vacancy.
- 14.8 An employee taking examinations within Malawi and wanting to take study leave prior to the commencement of examinations shall be granted study leave of maximum of two (2) weeks.

15 UNPAID STUDY LEAVE

Unpaid study leave shall be granted to an officer at the discretion of the Commissioner General. An officer can be granted unpaid study leave:

- 15.1 Where the officer has been with the Authority on continuous employment for five (5) years and more
- 15.2 Where the training programme is relevant, but the officer in question is not on the prioritized long term plans of the division.
- 15.3 Where the officer has been awarded a self-initiated scholarship to study in a field that is relevant to the duties and responsibilities of the officer
- 15.4 Where the officer intends to sponsor himself/herself to study in a field that is relevant to his/her duties and responsibilities.
- 15.5 The period of the unpaid study leave shall be the same as that of the training programme and no extension shall be granted beyond the study duration unless circumstances beyond the control of the officer necessitates the officer to extend the duration.
- 15.6 The officer will be requested to seek the approval of the Director of Human Resources of the intention to extend the duration and the justification thereof, failure of which will be construed as a disciplinary matter
- 15.7 Upon being granted unpaid study leave, the officer shall be required to submit academic progress reports
- 15.8 Officers who proceed on training on their own on unpaid study leave shall also be required to enter into an undertaking binding them to continue and remain in the service of MRA for a period of not less than study period

for PhDs and not less than two (2) years for rest of the programmes from the date of completion of their training.

- 15.9 Officers who deliberately decide to leave the Authority before the expiry of the bonding period shall be required to pay the Authority a sum of money equivalent to 50% of their salary and expenses for the Authority spent for the duration of the study period for the remaining unserved bond duration given by the Authority for purposes of attending the training.

16 TRAINING ALLOWANCES

16.1 Local Training

MRA funded courses – all grades	All costs to be paid by MRA plus normal prevailing subsistence allowances.
Donor funded courses – all grades	Difference of the allowance paid by the donor and the prevailing subsistence allowance rates by MRA where the donor's rate is lower

16.2 Foreign Training and External Training allowance

Training needs that cannot be met in-house or locally will be sourced from abroad (within Africa) or overseas.

MRA funded

Short term training	- As per the prevailing MRA daily rate for up to one month
Training courses of more than one month but less than one academic year	- As per the MRA schedule of Allowances
Long term or graduate academic year or more	-As per the MRA schedule of Allowances

Donor funded Courses

Donor funded courses or seminars	- As per the MRA schedule of Allowances
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- 16.2.1 As a principle, the ITA shall endeavour to get detailed information about the nature of sponsorship before submitting the application to the Training Committee.
- 16.2.2 Where it is deemed that the sponsorship is fully funded, MRA shall not pay the individual any top up allowances. A fully funded sponsorship

is where all costs including incidental allowances are taken care of by the sponsor.

- 16.2.3 For PhDs, MRA shall pay the individual only 50% of all the applicable allowances at the time the person is attending the training.
- 16.2.4 For PhDs where the tuition fees are not paid by MRA and the officer has taken educational loan, the Authority shall not pay the individual any allowances even in cases where all costs including incidental allowances are not taken care of by the sponsor as it shall be interpreted as self-funding.

16.3 Tuition and Examination Fees

- 16.3.1 The Authority shall pay tuition fees, residence and other mandatory fees such as pre-entry registration, any refundable deposit demanded and examination fees for the course of study at the institution providing the training.
- 16.3.2 Subsequent payment of tuition and examination fees shall be dependent on an employee submitting to Human Resource Division examination results of the previous semester, course, or academic year or depending on the fee structure.
- 16.3.3 Where fees are required for research projects or attachments which are mandatory as part of the course and have been advised to the Authority prior to commencement of the sponsorship, these shall be paid by the Authority.

16.4 Book Allowance and Study Materials

The Authority will pay expenses for books and study materials appropriate to the course of study only if it is not included in the tuition. In determining what is appropriate the Authority shall decide in consultation with training providers.

16.5 Travel to and from the place of Study

- 16.5.1 The Authority will pay for travel to and from the place of study locally or to any place outside Malawi. An employee travelling by air in Grade A 1 – B3 will travel business class and employees from Grade C1 below in economy class. Surface travel to and from the place of study shall be by coach, train or bus whichever is applicable.
- 16.5.2 Where paid foreign study leave has been granted to an employee he/she will be entitled to:
 - ✓ Return air/surface fares
 - ✓ Cost of shipping or surface freight of unaccompanied luggage of up to 100 kg that is personal and not commercial in nature
- 16.5.3 In the event of death of a spouse or registered dependant child, father/mother the sponsored employee will be provided with return

travel expenses to and from Malawi for the duration or normal compassionate leave entitlement plus travelling time.

16.6 Out of Pocket Allowance

- 16.6.1 An out of pocket allowance will be paid at prescribed rates to employees undergoing full time training where board and lodging is provided.
- 16.6.2 For PhDs, MRA shall pay the individual only 50% of all the applicable allowances at the time the person is attending the training.

16.7 Salary and Allowances

Full salary shall be paid whilst the employee is on an approved course of study, less all statutory and standing Authority's deductions. General salary reviews shall apply to all sponsored employees; however, no performance award shall apply to an employee who has worked for less than six (6) months in a year.

The sponsored employee shall continue to hold his/her position in his/her substantive pay scale that applied prior to the commencement of sponsorship.

16.8 Loans and Advances

Sponsored employees will continue to be eligible for salary advances and loans whilst on training.

16.9 Housing

Where an employee proceeds on training, leaving behind his/her family he/she will be allowed to retain the Authority housing and in all such cases rentals will be paid as per ruling rates.

16.10 Accrual of Leave Days

A sponsored employee will continue to accrue leave days for the first twelve months from the first day of his course, there after no leave will accrue to him.

16.11 Medical Treatment and Hospitalization

Employees attending local courses are expected to use medical facilities provided under the Authority's medical scheme.

Employees pursuing studies outside Malawi will be covered by the overseas medical insurance scheme.

When travelling to or from a foreign country the Authority will arrange for medical insurance for the period of training and travel.

16.12 Business and Maintenance Allowances

- i. Employees attending short courses, conferences, seminars, workshops and attachments of up to fourteen (14) days, will be paid subsistence allowance to cater for daily expenses while those attending longer courses will be paid maintenance and settling allowances at rates specified in the conditions of service.
- ii. Where accommodation and meals are being provided to the employee, the Authority shall pay a subsistence allowance at the prevailing rates for up to thirty (30) days after which it will be frozen.
- iii. Where a course or attachment is partly sponsored, the difference shall be paid by the Authority. For courses on attachments of longer duration the provisions under sections for study leave shall apply.

16.13 Warm Clothing Allowance

Warm clothing allowance as provided for in the prevailing rates, shall only be paid to employees proceeding on overseas courses and attachments.

17 BONDING

Employees proceeding on approved long term courses will be bonded to the Authority using the bonding form shown in **Appendix 4**.

As a condition of sponsorship, the employee will immediately upon completion of the course continue in the employment of the Malawi Revenue Authority for periods specified below:-

<u>Duration of full time course</u>	<u>Bonding Period</u>
Less than six (6) months	None
Six (6) to twelve (12) months	one (1) year
Twelve (12) months or more	two (2) years
PhD	equivalent to the study period

- 17.1 Failure to complete this service obligation will render the employee liable to pay all monies or dues proportionate to all paid training expenses with an interest at the prevailing rate effective at the date the sponsorship was granted, this also applies to those on block release programme (periodic learning program).

- 17.2 To accommodate the fact that an employee who complete his approved course internally and integrates his earning within his day to day work, the bonding shall be varied accordingly.
- 17.3 As a general principle, an employee cannot get another sponsorship whilst he/she is serving a bond.

18 WITHDRAWAL OF SPONSORSHIP

The Authority shall withdraw the sponsorship at any time for the following reasons:-

- 18.1 Unsatisfactory academic performance;
- 18.2 Inability to complete the course of study on account of illness or unauthorised absence from studies;
- 18.3 Expulsion from the course;
- 18.4 Failure to comply with any of the conditions of sponsorship as laid down by the Authority; and
- 18.5 Upon withdrawal, the Authority may undertake to recover the amount spent on the sponsorship. The withdrawal may amount to a warning and this shall be confirmed in writing.

19 TERMINATION / WITHDRAWAL OF PAID AND UNPAID STUDY LEAVE

Unpaid Study Leave and Paid Study shall be withdrawn or terminated for the following reasons:-

- 19.1 Where an employee decides to change course of study or training institution without prior approval and consent of the Training Committee,
- 19.2 Where an employee decides to extend the duration of the course of study without prior approval of the Human Resource Division
- 19.3 Where the Authority receives reports of non-attendance of classes by the employee,
- 19.4 Where the employee is found guilty of a serious misconduct contrary to the Conditions of Service of the Authority, regulations of the Training Institution or Sponsor, and
- 19.5 Where the employee is unable of continuing with his or her studies on health or academic grounds.

20 ACADEMIC PROGRESS

The Authority shall take note of any recommendations made by training providers concerning each employee's career progression and give academic assistance as required, but where the only viable option appears to be the termination of the sponsorship, such termination shall be effected without delay. To foster this, the Authority shall require that the training institution provide academic progress reports in the course of study.

20.1 Conduct for local & foreign Training

Whilst on training, employees will continue to be bound by the provisions of the Authority's conditions of service, disciplinary code as well as the rules and regulations relating to conduct.

21 THE TRAINING COMMITTEE

There shall be an established Training Committee which will be composed of Management members and shall be chaired by a member from the Business Area of MRA. The committee shall ensure that training is meeting MRA's business needs; priorities are planned properly, cost effective, properly resourced and are in conformity with the training and development strategy. They will in particular:-

- 1) Consider and approve training and development strategies, policies and procedures to meet Authority business needs.
- 2) Adjudicate on corporate basis on the proposed training needs identified by individual divisions in order to optimise the balance of training against the needs of the Authority and cost effectiveness.

21.1 Composition of Training Committee

The following shall be members of the Training Committee:-

- 1) Chair as appointed by the Commissioner General and to be rotated every two (2) years
- 2) Divisional Heads or delegates
- 3) Learning and Organisational Development Manager as Secretary

21.2 The Committee shall:

- 1) Consider and approve training and development strategies, policies and procedures to meet the Authority's business needs (ensuring that training meets MRA's strategic needs)
- 2) Adjudicate on corporate basis on the proposed training needs identified by individual divisions in order to optimise the balance of training against the needs of the Authority and cost effectiveness (that it is effective and properly sourced)
- 3) Review quarterly and annual training plans of the authority consolidated by the Director of Human Resources and Organization Development

- 4) Approve training plan/calendar based on clearly identified training needs
- 5) Consider and approve requests for study leave, course approval and education loan applications from individual employees when and as it is necessary
- 6) Scrutinize quarterly and annual training reports to enhance the efficiency and effectiveness of training interventions.
- 7) Review employee Skills gaps and benchmark skills for key positions in MRA and ensure that it is in conformity with the Training Development Strategy, Succession Planning, Talent Management and Performance Management
- 8) Ensure that there is always an active training plan in place at the start of every financial year to cover the forthcoming twelve (12) month period
- 9) Ensure that sufficient funding is set aside in the financial budget to cover the planned training expenditure for the current/impending financial year
- 10) Ensure that Post Training Assessments are carried out and reported by the Institute of Tax Administration (ITA)
- 11) Annually review training charter and committee work plan
- 12) With support from DHR annually review committees work and the objectives it has committed itself to and report the same to Management

22 EVALUATING TRAINING

All MRA Training and development interventions will be evaluated in order to:-

1. Ensure that the effectiveness of investment made in training is appraised in general terms and provide data, which can justify expenditure on training.
2. Provide feedback to trainers mostly at Institute of Tax Administration about their performance and methods thereby improving their training skills.
3. Enable improvements to be made as training proceeds.

4. Determining to what extent the objectives have been met and whether any further training needs remain.

In order for training evaluation to be effective, trainers, line managers and trainees need to cooperate in the process, as each will bring different perspectives to the process. MRA training and development activities will be evaluated at four different levels as follows:-

Level 1

This will involve reactions of trainees to the content and methods of training, to trainers and to any factors perceived as relevant. What did the trainee think about training?

This evaluation will be conducted during and immediately after the training and submitted to the Human Resources Department.

Level 2

At this level learning will be measured during the training period. Did the trainees learn what was intended?

This evaluation will be done during and immediately after the course.

This evaluation will take different forms e.g. exercise, tests and examinations which are to be administered by resource persons and their results consolidated by course coordinators. Copies of any relevant information and examination results are to be sent to the Human Resource Department where reports to the Commissioners/Directors, will be made for their comments.

Level 3

At this level evaluation will be done so as to measure job behaviour in the work environment at the end of the training period.

The line manager to determine whether training has helped in bridging the performance gap of an individual will carry out this evaluation. The evaluation will be carried out within six (3) to six (6) months after the course.

At this level of course evaluation, participants will use Action Plans, i.e. what goals they will achieve arising from the training process.

REFERENCE TO OTHER POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

This Policy must be read in conjunction with MRA Terms and Conditions of Services, Succession and Talent Management Policy and any other MRA Human Resources Policies in existence at any time.

DISTRIBUTION

The Human Resources Division will ensure that this policy is circulated to all staff.

REVIEW AND REVISION

The Authority reserves the right to review or amend this Policy and all Authority policies, at any time.

APPENDICES



MALAWI REVENUE AUTHORITY
INSTITUTE OF TAX ADMINISTRATION

TRAINING NEEDS ASSESSMENT FORM

1. PERSONAL DETAILS

- NAME: Mr/Mrs/Ms
- DATE OF BIRTH
- STATION:
- DEPARTMENT AND SECTION:
- DATE OF FIRST APPOINTMENT:
- POSITION AND GRADE AT FIRST APPOINTMENT:
- CURRENT POST:
- CURRENT GRADE:
- Education Record (State):
 - ✓ Masters:
 - ✓ Bachelors:
 - ✓ Professional Qualification:
 - ✓ MSCE/JCE:

2. TRAINING COURSES ATTENDED FOR THE PAST THREE YEARS

<u>Date / Year</u>	<u>Name of course</u>	Training <u>institution /Venue</u>	<u>Duration</u>
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3. Are there any factors which have been hindering you from applying the skills acquired from the trainings listed above?

4. Do you think you are placed on the right position where your qualifications and competencies are marching with job requirements?

Yes / No

5. Where in your opinion, would you place yourself within the MRA structure considering your experience, qualifications and competencies?

6. Are there any skill gaps that have been identified in you by the authority through performance appraisals or any other means?

State them

7. Personally, as I do my daily work, I find myself to have inadequate skills in the following areas and I feel training in the stated areas named in the next item would enhance the listed skill gaps

8. Complete the competence chart for the key tasks that you carry out in your job, using the rating scale below the table.

RATED COMPETENCE CHART FOR SKILLS				
Key Tasks of the job (List in order of priority)	Key skills or abilities required to perform the task to standard	How do you rate yourself in this skill? (1 – 5)	Do you require training in this skill? Yes or No	If yes – give proposed Training

SKILLS/PERFORMANCE RATING SCALE

1. *Has limited knowledge, skill and expertise, not sufficient for acceptable task performance.*

2. *Can perform some parts of the task satisfactorily, requiring instruction or constant supervision to accomplish it fully.*
3. *Can perform the task satisfactorily, requiring only periodic assistance or supervision.*
4. *Can perform the task satisfactorily, without assistance or supervision, with proficiency, speed and Initiative.*
5. *Can perform the task with assistance or supervision, with proficiency, speed and initiative, and can adapt to and resolve special problem situations as they occur.*
9. Describe briefly the justification for the preferred trainings proposed above

10. Is there any other training required to improve your job performance?

11. In your opinion, how will the preferred training help you as an individual as well as MRA

As an individual

As for MRA

APPENDIX 2: TRAINING PLAN FORMAT

Employee Name	Age	Position	Summary Of Key Duties	Present Highest Qualification	Proposed Course of Study	Training Institution	Course Duration	Justification for Proposed Training	Estimated Cost

		BACK TO OFFICE REPORT		DATE	
NAME:			POSITION:		
DIVISION:		STATION/SECTION:		GRADE:	
TRAINING TITLE:				DATES & LOCATION OF TRAINING:	
1. PURPOSE/OBJECTIVE OF TRAINING: <i>(Attach documents, if necessary)</i>					
2. BRIEF SUMMARY OF TRAINING OUTCOMES:					
3. KEY RECOMMENDATIONS:					
4. ACTIONS TO BE TAKEN BY PARTICIPANT & DUE DATE: <i>(e.g; presentation of what was learnt to others in the Section; Implementation of the recommendations; how you are going to do your job differently; introduce new ways or processes based on lessons learnt ,etc)</i>					
SIGNATURE OF PARTICIPANT:					
SECTION/DIVISION HEAD INITIAL COMMENTS:					
NAME		SIGNATURE :		DATE	
DIRECTOR, HUMAN RESOURCE & OD		SIGNATURE :		DATE	
SECTION/DIVISION HEAD POST REVIEW COMMENTS AFTER IMPLEMENTATION OF ACTION POINTS:					



MALAWI REVENUE AUTHORITY

Training Bond

THIS DEED IS MADE theday oftwo thousand andbetween the Malawi Revenue Authority (hereinafter called “MRA”) of Private Bag 247, Blantyre, of the one part andwho is currently working for the MRA (hereinafter called “the Employee”) of the other part.

WHEREAS the employee is currently pursuing a course of study leading to (hereinafter called “the Course”) tenable at (hereinafter called “the institution”)

AND WHEREAS the MRA has agreed with the Employee that the MRA will (here state whether MRA will let employee get sponsorship or go on paid study leave) for period of Years.

NOW THIS DEED WITNESSETH AS follows:

- (a) The **MRA COVENANTS WITH THE** employee subject to this agreement to allot on behalf of the Employee such moneys for the payment of his/her salary and benefits during the period of Training.
- (b) **THE EMPLOYEE COVENANTS WITH THE MRA**
 - (1) To commence the requisite journeys from his/her station to the institution in sufficient time to ensure his/her attendance at the institution on the date and the time specified for his/her said attendance and to proceed thereto without

any unnecessary or unwarranted stopovers or delays save as agreed to beforehand with the MRA.

- (2) To comply with all requirements of the institution as regards discipline and attendance at lectures, shop or field work and to attend and submit to all examinations as may be required in relation to the course of study during the period of the course.
- (3) To furnish the MRA with copies of examination results within a reasonable time after receiving the same and to allow the MRA access to the institution's reports evaluating of his/her performance.
- (4) To diligently to apply himself/herself to all studies and other work assigned to him/her in relation to the course during the period thereof.
- (5) Upon completion by himself/herself of the course or earlier, if so directed by the MRA, to return to Malawi and report for duty as soon as maybe practicable after such return. Provided that the Employee can only be recalled in accordance with part "B" hereunder.
- (6) Upon completion by himself/herself of the course or his/her earlier recall, as the case maybe, to continue and remain in the service of the MRA if the MRA so requires him/her for the period as stated in the Training Policy i.e.....

(c) **THE EMPLOYEE FURTHER COVENANTS THAT:**

- (i) In the event of a breach of this agreement by his/her deliberate failure or refusal to remain and continue in the service of the MRA for the period required of him/her in accordance with this agreement or by his/her leaving the said service without prior written consent of the MRA before the expiry of such period, the Employee whereby agrees and consents to be bound to the payment by him/her to MRA of a sum of money

equivalent to the total amount the MRA spent on him/her during the period of study with 15 per centum interest from the date of the breach.

PROVIDED that where the Employee resigns or leaves the employ of MRA after having served for a period of time after completion of the course, the amount of money payable by him/her to the MRA shall be reduced in proportion to the expired period of the bond.

PROVIDED FURTHER that nothing contained in this deed is meant to create or to impose nor shall anything HEREIN be constituted as creating or imposing any liability or obligation on the part of the MRA to:

- (i) Settle any debts or liabilities incurred by the Employee.
 - (ii) Continue to employ the Employee for any particular period or in any capacity, after the Employee's return or recall from the course.
- B. (a) **THE PARTIES FURTHER AGREE THAT** the MRA shall have the powers to recall the Employee from the Institution earlier than the date of the completion of the study where circumstances so require.
- (b) The circumstances envisaged in (a) above shall be such that any reasonable employer would consider sufficient to justify an early recall of an Employee from studies and these shall include:-
- (i) Reports from the Institution of wilful and deliberate failure by the Employee to attend lectures or lessons.
 - (ii) Reports of continued absenteeism
 - (iii) Breach of any term hereof during the period of study
 - (iv) Reports of continued poor academic performance
 - (v) Reports of indiscipline and bad conduct that would put the name of the MRA in disrepute
- (c) Provided that the list in (b) above shall not be constructed as being exhaustive.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF the duly authorised representatives of the MRA and the Employee have set their hands hereto on the day, month, and year first above written.

The **COMMON SEAL** of the)
said **MRA** is hereunto affixed)
in the presence of)

WITNESS : _____

ADDRESS : _____

OCCUPATION : _____

DATE : _____

SIGNATURE : _____

SIGNED, SEALED and)
DELIVERED by the said)
.....)
in the presence of)

WITNESS : _____

ADDRESS : _____

OCCUPATION : _____

DATE : _____

SIGNATURE : _____

